BASANT BHATTARAI

SENIOR DATA ENGINEER / DATA & AI ARCHITECT

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PROFILE

Senior data engineer and data and AI architect with 9 years in software engineering, six of them owning production data platforms. Designs platforms, their data models and the governance and SOC 2 controls around them, then builds them. Open-source first — Kafka, Spark, Iceberg, Trino, dbt and Airflow on Kubernetes — plus the databases underneath: modeling, replication, backup and recovery, upgrades. Designs and runs the agent workflows on that same stack (LangGraph, Google ADK, MCP), so model output lands as typed, reviewable rows. Track record: 40% lower infrastructure cost, 50% faster processing, 60% faster analytics delivery.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Engineer | UXCam

Feb 2024 - present

- Own reliability and governance for a platform handling 15 TB+ and 100M+ events daily: freshness and latency objectives per dataset, 99.9% uptime, incident-ready runbooks, reviewable data contracts, a named owner for every published table, and the SOC 2 criteria met for the platform and its infrastructure through every audit.
- Design and operate the production agent workflows — LangGraph and Google ADK orchestration, MCP tool servers, retrieval and evaluation — against the existing platform, so model output lands as typed, provenanced rows rather than a transcript: analytics delivery 60% faster with 75% less analyst effort, review and fallback paths kept.
- Lead architecture and operational review across ingestion, storage, serving, observability and recovery.
- Treat capacity and cost as design inputs, with storage layout, partitioning and compaction as the levers.
- Mentor 5 engineers through pairing, code review and written design feedback; team delivery time down 30%, with the emphasis on making system ownership transferable.

Data Engineer | UXCam

Feb 2020 - Feb 2024

- Built and operated batch and streaming pipelines, then took on the data models, orchestration, storage and analytical serving paths around them.
- Rebuilt the core ETL layer in Spark and PySpark with Airflow orchestration, cutting processing time for 5 TB+/day by 50% and unblocking real-time product dashboards.
- Made change and recovery safe by treating schema evolution, replay, late-arriving data and backfills as designed interfaces with idempotent loads and explicit watermarks, not as emergency procedures.
- Tuned Trino, ClickHouse, Citus and TimescaleDB serving 100M+ queries/day for a 50% p95 latency reduction through partitioning, clustering and model redesign.
- Led the Kubernetes migration of the data infrastructure: 40% lower infrastructure cost, 99.9% uptime, and autoscaling that held under peak load.

Project Leader | SVCET, India

2019 - 2020

- Led 4 developers building an intelligent dialogue system on an NLP and deep-learning stack, reaching the client's acceptance threshold for intent recognition and delivering 2 weeks ahead of schedule.
- Coordinated requirements, planning and review across academic and industry stakeholders, and introduced the code-review and version-control discipline the department kept afterwards.

Software Developer | SV Technology, India

2017 - 2019

- Built Python and FastAPI backend services carrying 10K+ users at 85% test coverage.
- Designed and maintained PostgreSQL schemas, stored procedures and reporting paths, and set up CI with Jenkins alongside the early pipeline work that moved me into data engineering.

SELECTED OPEN SOURCE

- **data-platform-architecture** and **ai-platform-architecture** (reference architectures): a SaaS company leaving Postgres, measured: 18 decision records, a Kimball model, SOC 2 readiness, a cost model and a Databricks proof of concept; then its usage assistant on governed data.
- **spark-sql-kinesis** (maintainer): Kinesis source and sink for Spark 4.2 on AWS SDK v2, on Maven Central; an idle shard costs one GetRecords call, not a multi-second floor per batch.
- **evalproof**: LLM evaluation with judge calibration and CI gates that fail only on drops that are both large and significant.
- **distributed-db-lab**: Citus sharding, online rebalance and tenant isolation, measured against TimescaleDB and replicated ClickHouse. Also data-stack-lab, a governed agent, streaming, real-time ML, retrieval, data contracts and GitOps delivery. github.com/technobasant

CAPABILITY MAP

Platform ownership

Consumer-facing reliability, governance, recovery and operational readiness.

Python, SQL and Scala; Kafka and Kinesis ingestion (maintainer of an open-source Spark 4 Kinesis connector); Spark/PySpark processing, including the Spark 4 migration; Airflow orchestration; Iceberg, Hive Metastore, dbt and lakehouse modeling; Databricks with Unity Catalog; Kubernetes, Docker and Terraform delivery; contracts, lineage, cost and recovery.

Data and system architecture

Platforms chosen on evidence, with every decision written down.

Conceptual to physical modelling, Kimball and Type 2 history, lakehouse, ClickHouse and Citus layouts, contracts in CI, decision records, SOC 2 and erasure by design, cost models.

Database lifecycle

Modeling, replication, failover, backup and PITR, upgrades and query performance.

PostgreSQL, ClickHouse, Trino, Citus, TimescaleDB, Redis and MongoDB; partitioning, replication, restore and high availability.

Agentic systems

Model output that lands as typed, reviewable rows rather than a transcript.

LangGraph, LangChain, Google ADK, MCP servers, Pydantic, Milvus and MLflow; bounded tools, retrieval, evaluation before rollout, provenance, human review and honest fallback paths.

Technical leadership

Design review, mentoring, runbooks, and making system ownership transferable.

Architecture and operational review, mentoring, runbooks, service and freshness objectives, Prometheus and Grafana.

Cloud

AWS: S3, EKS (IRSA), Lambda, Glue, Athena, Redshift, Kinesis, EMR | **GCP:** BigQuery, Dataflow, Dataproc, Datastream, Pub/Sub, Cloud Composer, GKE, Vertex AI | **Azure:** Synapse, Data Factory, Databricks, ADLS, Event Hubs, AKS, Azure ML

EDUCATION AND LANGUAGES

Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science and Engineering

JNTUA College of Engineering, Anantapur, India | 2015 - 2019

English: C1 | Nepali: native

Selected work, writing and case studies: basantbhattarai.com.np/work/